My name is Norman Sanders and for the first time in my life at 20 years old, I have been incarcerated for more than 100 days in Jerome County Correctional Facility in Jerome, Idaho. Over the course of my stay here I have observed an overall lack of fundamental programming. Almost no educational classes or programs with the exception of AA meetings which I was placed on a waiting list to attend but have yet to be called for. I was informed of another recovery style class named Reformers Unanimous, recently renamed H.O.P.E, which is a religion based recovery program for all types of addiction. I signed up, waited three weeks and finally was called to my first class. That one session was the only one I got to attend, I have not been called out since. Nor have I heard of anyone else being able to attend. Point being, I expected a more institutionalized facility with at least some sort of recreational value rather than a small block of 15 men and a television. Four tablets provided with a <u>free</u> education program that inmates are required to pay for, yet most cannot afford (including myself.) It's no wonder fights break out, there's so little to occupy our time it becomes maddening. On the free section of the tablet, there is nothing of importance aside from a request

feature that allows inmates to contact the medical department, jail clerk, and legal assistance. I do understand that jail is not meant to be a pleasurable, home away from home experience, but I also believe in reform and there are so many people willing to change, they just lack the tools to help get it done. The Khan Academy has proven to be a valuable asset, very useful to those who want more. But the price factor puts it just beyond reach for most of us. In all reality, it should be a free service to all who wish to utilize it. With so much going on in the world today, I firmly believe that it's the little things like this that we do for each other as a society that is going to change the future for the better. This is where it starts. Thank you for your time in reading this and I hope it helps improve lives in the future.

Norman Sanders
Oct. 31, 2022

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